

Concrete Project Cost & Quantity Handbook

Volume, thickness, delivery, reinforcement, forms and placement planning

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Plan first. Price second.

This 12-page field guide is designed to be used beside HomeCostEngine calculators, measurements, product selections and contractor proposals. It does not try to replace a site inspection or local professional. Instead, it helps you make assumptions visible so quotes become easier to understand and compare.

Contents

1. Calculate theoretical volume
2. Choose thickness for the use
3. Prepare the base and forms
4. Compare ready-mix and bags
5. Plan reinforcement and joints
6. Plan placement and curing
7. Compare concrete proposals
8. Project checklist
9. Budget worksheet
10. Next steps

Use this guide for planning and education only. Verify final pricing, code, permits, suitability and scope with qualified local professionals.

CONCRETE

Calculate theoretical volume

Measure length, width and thickness, convert the result to cubic yards and keep the math visible. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for ordering from square footage without accounting for slab thickness. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Record dimensions and theoretical yards before adding an allowance.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

What is the one assumption on this page that could change your price or contractor scope? Write it down before moving to the next chapter.

CONCRETE

Choose thickness for the use

Base thickness on the project, loads, soil and design requirements rather than price alone. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for reducing thickness only to lower material quantity. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Confirm structural or code requirements where applicable.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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CONCRETE

Prepare the base and forms

Plan excavation, base material, compaction, elevation and form accuracy. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for low spots or bowed forms that silently increase concrete volume. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Check several depth points before ordering.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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CONCRETE

Compare ready-mix and bags

Include bag yield, mixing labor, truck minimums, delivery and placement access. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for comparing only material price while ignoring labor and short-load charges. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Calculate the complete delivered and placement cost.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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Plan reinforcement and joints

Define reinforcement, control joints, isolation details and any thickened edges or footings. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for treating reinforcement and joint layout as generic extras. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Write design assumptions into the contractor scope.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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Plan placement and curing

Coordinate crew size, weather, finishing, protection and curing before concrete arrives. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for a pour schedule with no weather or backup plan. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Confirm who can postpone and how fresh concrete will be protected.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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CONCRETE

Compare concrete proposals

Match excavation, base, forms, concrete specification, pump, finishing, cleanup and haul-off. The purpose is to turn a broad project assumption into something you can measure, price or confirm in writing. Keep homeowner decisions separate from items that require a site inspection, product specification or local professional review.

Watch for quotes that use the same slab dimensions but include very different prep work. If a proposal or plan leaves this point unclear, do not bury it inside the total. Record the assumption, ask who is responsible, and decide whether it belongs in fixed scope, an allowance, a unit price or contingency.

Action plan

- Normalize each proposal to the same written scope.
- Write the supporting measurement, quote line or product selection next to this decision.
- Update the working budget as soon as the assumption changes.

FIELD NOTE

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Project checklist

Resolve or document each item before you approve the final scope or purchase decision.

- Dimensions verified
- Thickness confirmed
- Base preparation included
- Yards calculated
- Delivery and access plan
- Reinforcement and joints
- Finish and curing scope

CHECKPOINT

Any unchecked item is not automatically a problem. It is a prompt to clarify responsibility, price or assumptions in writing before money is committed.

WORKING DOCUMENT

Budget worksheet

Keep planned amounts, actual quotes and notes together. Do not hide allowances or contingency inside one total.

Concrete material	Planned: \$ _____
Delivery or short-load	Planned: \$ _____
Excavation	Planned: \$ _____
Base material	Planned: \$ _____
Forms	Planned: \$ _____
Reinforcement	Planned: \$ _____
Pump and placement	Planned: \$ _____
Finishing and cleanup	Planned: \$ _____

Update this worksheet whenever a quote, selection or change order changes the project.

Next steps

You now have a practical framework for concrete planning. Move from generic assumptions to real measurements, written product selections and comparable local proposals as your project becomes more defined.

Use HomeCostEngine next

- Run the relevant free calculator at homecostengine.com.
- Compare contractor proposals with matching scope and allowances.
- Keep a separate contingency instead of hiding uncertainty inside fixed costs.
- Save this guide with your quotes, selections and final project records.

HOME COST PLANNING - CLEARER ASSUMPTIONS - BETTER QUESTIONS

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Educational planning resource only. Always verify project-specific decisions with qualified local professionals.